

Ling 150A1 Language in the World

Summer 2024

Revisions to Nondiscrimination and Anti-harassment policy, and to Additional Resources for Students, approved by Faculty Senate, 12/8/20.

Revisions to Campus Safety information and links 4/7/23.

Description of Course

All human communities have language - and our language is central to our lives. We use language not only to communicate with each other, we use it in our dreams, in our art, and some have even argued that language is the stuff of thought itself. This course introduces concepts and methods in linguistics - the scientific study of language - along with important concepts and tools from psychology, anthropology, biology, computation, and philosophy.

Enrollment Requirements

Enrollment is not allowed if you have previously taken INDV 101 "Language" (Topic 3).

Instructor and Contact Information

Instructor: Asma

Email: asma1@arizona.edu

Course web page in D2l only: <https://d2l.arizona.edu/d2l/home/1306398>

Course Format and Teaching Methods

It is an asynchronous class. The lectures will be uploaded online on panopto and the links will be available on the d2l website. Weekly discussion topics and readings will also be available on the d2l website. If there is any confusion, you can email the instructor.

Course Objectives

Students successfully completing this course will learn to...

- Investigate the organizations of diversity found in language and languages through time and space, around a core principle of functional equivalence of natural human languages and the status of language rights as human rights in the human brain.
- Communicate and explain how interdisciplinary approaches contribute to understanding language and languages in human societies around the world.
- Articulate the strengths and consequences of approaching language structure and language behavior through various disciplinary lenses.
- Use core values, concepts, theories, and methods from structural, documentary and community-based linguistics to investigate the nature of language.
- Analyze how social, environmental, institutional, and other systemic structures influence how knowledge is constructed in the domain of language.

- Identify the primary languages and communities that are indigenous to the Tucson basin and describe the ways in which these languages are present and vital components of our shared linguistic environment.
- Discuss how knowledge about languages in the world has been produced and how this knowledge has been distributed unequally, as well as ways in which we are empowered to begin to address these issues.
- Use the analytical tools of linguistics and anthropology, among other disciplines, to explore ways in which languages around the world are enmeshed with communities, environments, and worldviews.
- Reflect on how your own language background is related to your identity and perceptions of your own linguistic behavior, and that of others.
- Explain the phenomena of language endangerment, language reclamation, language construction, and language revitalization and the ways in which minoritization of languages, and of language varieties associated with particular social and cultural groups result in systemic inequities in our world, and find ways to remediate these forces.

Expected Learning Outcomes

Students will improve their skills in...

- Reading for understanding, and applying that knowledge to analyze new information.
- Writing effectively for a scholarly audience.
- Integrating creativity with analysis in a multi-step, long-term project.
- Presenting complex information clearly, consistently and effectively to a reader.
- Applying a referencing and citation stylesheet accurately to your written work.
- Responding effectively to feedback.
- Managing work to comfortably meet deadlines, manage data to ensure that work is protected, and utilize technical support appropriately.

Resources:

To be successful in this course you will need to access and use this website (d2l), which requires...

- that you bookmark and use the University's 24/7 IT Support resources when you have a technical problem
- that you bookmark and use the D2L Help Pages when you need help figuring out how to navigate or access resources here (including the Zoom and Panopto integrations listed under 'UA Tools')
 - We will be using Zoom for meetings (if you schedule one).
 - We will be providing class videos hosted by Panopto.
 - Our required course resources include videos, web pages, pdf documents, and google docs. Our goal is to ensure that all course resources are accessible. If you encounter difficulties with any of these resources, please contact Asma (asma1@arizona.edu) asap!

Required Texts or Readings

There are no texts to purchase for this class. All required materials are available on the course webpage (D2L).

Assignments and Examinations: Schedule/Due Dates

This course does not have any exams. You will receive points by submitting assignments, discussion posts, and comments on readings. The assignments will be creative and fun. You will have a total of 4 assignments.

Final Examination

There are no exams; all the evaluations will be based on coursework during the semester.

Grading Scale and Policies

The course is offered with A/B/C/D/E grading.

100 points can be earned on coursework throughout the semester. Points earned correspond to the letter grades as follows (and hopefully as expected):

- <60 = E
- 60-69 = D
- 70-79 = C
- 80-89 = B
- 90-100 = A

You will earn credit as follows:

- 10 Discussion posts. (5 on weekly topics and 5 on readings.) = 20 points.
- Assignment 1 = 10 points.
- Assignment 2 = 20 points.
- Assignment 3 = 20 points.
- Assignment 4 = 30 points.

Incomplete (I) or Withdrawal (W):

Requests for incomplete (I) or withdrawal (W) must be made in accordance with University policies, which are available at <http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/grades-and-grading-system#incomplete> and <http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/grades-and-grading-system#Withdrawal> respectively.

Scheduled Topics/Activities:

I may or may not follow this calendar strictly. If I make any changes I will let you know.

Date	Lecture	Activity
Week 1		
Jul 08, 2023	Introduction	Discussion post 1 Reading post 1
Jul 09, 2023	Anthropology, Archeology, and History	
Jul 10, 2023	Anthropology, Archeology and History	

Jul 14, 2023	-	Last day to submit weekly activities.
Week 2		
Jul 15, 2023	Phonetics	Discussion post 2 Reading post 2 Assignment 1
Jul 16, 2023	Phonetics and Phonology	
Jul 17, 2023	Phonology	
Jul 21, 2023	-	Last day to submit weekly activities.
Week 3		
Jul 22, 2023	Semantics	Discussion post 3 Reading 3 Assignment 2
Jul 23, 2023	Semantics and Morphology	
Jul 24, 2023	Morphology	
Jul 28, 2023	-	Last day to submit weekly activities.
Week 4		
Jul 29, 2023	Syntax	Discussion post 4 Reading 4 Assignment 3
Aug 30, 2023	Syntax and Pragmatics	
Aug 1, 2023	Pragmatics	
Aug 4, 2023	-	Last day to submit weekly activities.
Week 5		
Aug 5, 2023	Psycholinguistics	Discussion post 5 Reading 5 Assignment 4
Aug 6, 2023	Neurolinguistics	
Aug 7, 2023	Computational Linguistics	

Aug 11, 2023	-	Last day to submit weekly activities.
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Classroom Behavior Policy

To foster a positive learning environment, students and instructors have a shared responsibility. We want a safe, welcoming, and inclusive environment where all of us feel comfortable with each other and where we can challenge ourselves to succeed. To that end, our focus is on the tasks at hand and not on extraneous activities (e.g., texting, chatting, reading a newspaper, making phone calls, web surfing, etc.).

Additional Resources for Students

UA Academic policies and procedures are available at <http://catalog.arizona.edu/policies>

Campus Health

<http://www.health.arizona.edu/>

Campus Health provides quality medical and mental health care services through virtual and in-person care.

Phone: 520-621-9202

Counseling and Psych Services (CAPS)

<https://health.arizona.edu/counseling-psych-services>

CAPS provides mental health care, including short-term counseling services.

Phone: 520-621-3334

The Dean of Students Office's Student Assistance Program

<http://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/student-assistance/students/student-assistance>

Student Assistance helps students manage crises, life traumas, and other barriers that impede success. The staff addresses the needs of students who experience issues related to social adjustment, academic challenges, psychological health, physical health, victimization, and relationship issues, through a variety of interventions, referrals, and follow up services.

Email: DOS-deanofstudents@email.arizona.edu

Phone: 520-621-7057

Survivor Advocacy Program

<https://survivoradvocacy.arizona.edu/>

The Survivor Advocacy Program provides confidential support and advocacy services to student survivors of sexual and gender-based violence. The Program can also advise students about relevant non-UA resources available within the local community for support.

Email: survivoradvocacy@email.arizona.edu

Phone: 520-621-5767

Confidentiality of Student Records

<http://www.registrar.arizona.edu/ferpa>

University-wide Policies link

Links to the following UA policies are provided here, <http://catalog.arizona.edu/syllabus-policies>:

- Absence and Class Participation Policies
- Threatening Behavior Policy

- Accessibility and Accommodations Policy
- Code of Academic Integrity
- Nondiscrimination and Anti-Harassment Policy
- Subject to Change Statement